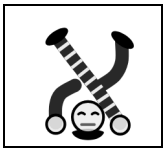
# **Aleph** · Memory chain · 27 letters you will not forget

**1** Aleph

א

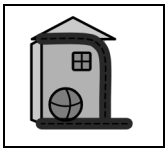


**uh-oh**

אַבָּא father

**2** Bet

ב

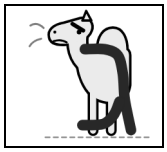


**ball**

בַּיִת house

**3** Gimel

ג

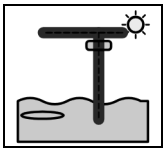


**grumpy**

גָּמָל camel

**4** Dalet

ד



**dive**

דֶּלֶת door

**5** He

ה

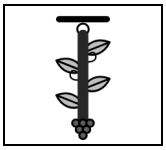


**hut**

הַר mountain

**6** Vav

ו

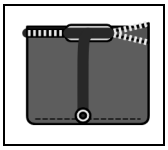


**vine**

וָו hook

**7** Zayin

ז

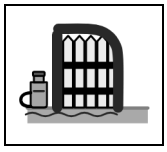


**zipper**

זָהָב gold

**8** Chet

ח



**loch**

חָלָב milk

**S** differ: see note 8

**9** Tet

ט

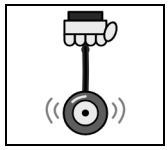


**tea**

טֶלֶפוֹן telephone

**10** Yod

י

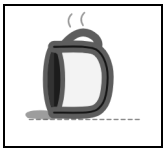


**yo-yo**

יָד arm

**11** Kaf

כ



**cup**

כַּף palm

**12** Lamed

ל



**lamp**

לֶחֶם bread

**13** Mem

מ

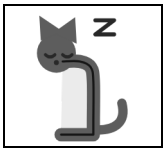


**mailbox**

מַיִם water

**14** Nun

נ

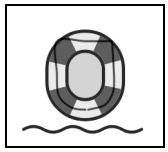


**nap**

נֵר candle

**15** Samekh

ס

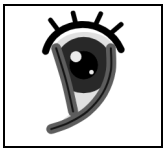


**swim ring**

סֵפֶר book

**16** Ayin

ע



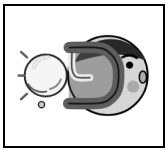
**eye**

עַיִן eye

**S** differ: see note 16

**17** Pe

פ

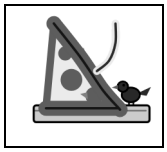


**pop**

פֶּה mouth

**18** Tsadi

צ

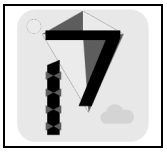


**pizza**

צִפּוֹר bird

**19** Qof

ק

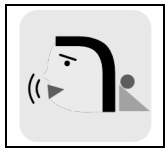


**kite**

קַו line

**20** Resh

ר



**round**

רֹאשׁ head

**I S A** differ: see note 20

**21** Shin

ש

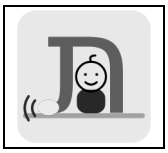


**shortcake**

שָׁלוֹם peace

**22** Tav

ת

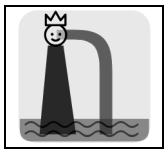


**table**

תִּינוֹק baby

**23** Final Kaf (final form)

ך



**loch**

מֶלֶךְ king

**24** Final Mem (final form)

ם

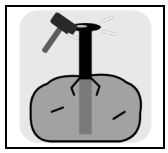


**mom**

יָם sea

**25** Final Nun (final form)

ן

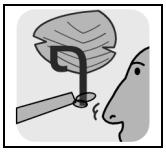


**nail**

אֶבֶן stone

**26** Final Pe (final form)

ף

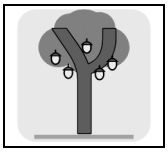


**feather**

אַף nose

**27** Final Tsadi (final form)

ץ



**nuts**

עֵץ tree

**How to read a cell.** Thick-framed box: the letter. Framed picture: what the letter turns into. Bold word: the hook, a sound you already know. Under it: a Hebrew word that starts with or contains the letter, and what it means. ▭ A double border marks the five final forms (sofit), used only at the end of a word. A small line with **I S A** appears only where the traditions say the letter differently.

**Notes where the traditions differ.**

**8 Chet. S** pharyngeal [ħ], a throat sound (the ch of Bach / loch is the Israeli merged value).

**16 Ayin. S** pharyngeal [ʕ] (Western Sephardim [ŋ]); silent in Israeli and Ashkenazi.

**20 Resh. I** Real sound: back-of-the-throat r (like French or German r), not the English r · **S** Real sound: front r, rolled or tapped (like Spanish r) · **A** Real sound: r varies by regional dialect: front (alveolar) or back-of-the-throat (uvular)

**Three ways to say it. I** Israeli: everyday modern Hebrew (the default here). **S** Sephardi, as the app's setting: Israeli-style vowels said with English-speaking habits. **A** Ashkenazi: the traditional siddur reading, for example Shabbos for Shabbat. Pick one and keep to it. The picture hooks use the Israeli sound.